This lemon, chicken, and rice soup is claimed by countries across the eastern Mediterranean. The stock must be well flavored, or it will not withstand the lemon juice.

avgolemone

SERVES 4 **PREP** 5 MINS **COOK** 20 MINS **FREEZE** NOT SUITABLE

¼ cup long-grain rice
1¼ quarts (1¼ liters) well-flavored chicken stock
3 eggs
juice of 1 large lemon
salt and freshly ground black pepper
lemon wedges, to serve

1 Bring the rice and stock to a boil in a saucepan. Simmer, uncovered, for 15 minutes, or until the rice is completely cooked.

2 Whisk the eggs and lemon juice in a bowl until the mixture becomes frothy. Add a ladleful of hot stock and continue to whisk.

3 Remove the rice and stock from direct heat. Whisk the egg, lemon, and stock mixture into it. Return to the heat and cook gently and briefly at a temperature below boiling point, whisking until the texture is velvety—do not allow to boil. Season with salt and pepper and serve with lemon wedges.